PLAYBOOK · 5 WHYS

Stop fixing the same miss twice

A root cause playbook for planners and warehouse leads

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SUPPLY CHAIN 101 · 5 WHYS

What the 5 Whys is

- Ask why, then ask why of that answer
- Stop at a process you can change
- Usually 3 to 5 rounds, not exactly five

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STEP 1 · DEFINE

Write the miss as a fact

- What, where, when and how much
- Illustrative: one SKU missed two trucks
- No names, no guesses

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STEP 2 · ASK

Ask why with the floor

- Bring the picker, planner and driver
- Every answer needs evidence: a report or scan
- Two causes? Run two chains

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STEP 3 · ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

One missed truck, five whys

- Not loaded → pick face empty → top-up late
- Top-up late → min level in system is old
- Old min level → no owner after a pack change

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STEP 4 · FIX

Fix the process, not the person

- Name an owner and a review date
- Change the rule, SOP or master data
- Check in 30 days: did it come back?

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THE TAKEAWAY

If it comes back, you fixed a symptom

Save this for your next review.

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